THE COMMIT BOOK

THE COMMIT BOOK · PLAYBOOK

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For HS athletes and parents asked about a deal. Checked 2026-11-05.
Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.
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> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises an offer, aid, a roster spot, playing time or income. Confirm every rule with each school's compliance office. `TO VERIFY` = not confirmed against a primary source on 2026-11-05. Not tax advice either: talk to a tax professional.

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1. TWO RULEBOOKS

High school NIL is set by your **state** and your **state high school association**, not the NCAA. Rules differ by state and change often. `TO VERIFY`: your state association's current NIL policy, before anything is signed. We don't summarize state rules in this edition.

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2. WHAT THE NCAA D1 MANUAL SAYS NOW

- Individuals may permit use of their name, image and likeness in noninstitutional activities and be paid (D1 Bylaw 22.1.2, adopted 6/6/25 eff. 7/1/25).
- A school can't guarantee a third-party NIL deal (Bylaw 22.1.1.1, adopted 10/1/25).
- A parent, guardian, lawyer or other representative may help negotiate unless the athlete waives that in writing (Bylaw 22.1.1(b)).
- **Reporting:** a recruit who enrolls at a D1 school must report every noninstitutional NIL contract or payment of **$600 or more** made from the first day of classes of junior year of high school (or first JUCO enrollment). Multiple payments from the same party count together (Bylaw 22.2.2.5.1, adopted 10/30/25).

So keep a record of every deal from junior year on.

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3. RECRUITING-INDUCEMENT RISK

A "deal" offered to get you to attend a particular college can create problems under recruiting rules. `TO VERIFY`: the specific 2026-27 D1 Bylaw 13/22 provisions on NIL as a recruiting inducement; ask the college's compliance office in writing before signing anything tied to a school.

4. THE 25-QUESTION DEAL CHECKLIST

1. Who is paying (legal name)? 2. Is it tied to any college? 3. Is it allowed by my state association? 4. Does it use school logos or uniforms? 5. Exact pay and when? 6. In writing? 7. Length of contract? 8. Exclusivity? 9. Who owns the content? 10. Can I cancel? 11. Penalties if I cancel? 12. Products I'd endorse (alcohol, gambling, vape = no)? 13. Time required? 14. Does it conflict with team rules? 15. Agent or fee involved? 16. Is the agent registered where required? (TO VERIFY by state) 17. Will a parent review? 18. Will a lawyer review? 19. Tax form issued? 20. Do I report it later ($600 rule)? 21. Does it promise a scholarship or roster spot? (red flag) 22. Is any payment contingent on where I commit? (red flag) 23. Who keeps records? 24. Can I share the contract with compliance? 25. What happens if I transfer schools?

5. RED FLAGS

Pay contingent on a college choice · "Sign today" pressure · Upfront fee to you · No written contract · Use of school marks without permission · Anyone guaranteeing a collegiate NIL amount.

6. TAXES

NIL income is generally taxable. Keep every payment record. TO VERIFY current IRS guidance with a tax professional.

7. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA D1 Manual, LSDBi 90008, checked 2026-11-05: Bylaws 22.1.1, 22.1.1.1, 22.1.2, 22.2.2.5.1.
- State association rules: TO VERIFY per state.